CHAPTER 1

OTHERS IN THE FAMILY

NORWAY AND DULUTH · ABOUT 1900

On Boots and Ore Boats

What Ruth knew about her grandfather came to her the way most family history comes: from her father, who told it often. Where the records and the family part company, this chapter says so; for Anders, no records have been consulted yet, so everything here is the family's account.

The Calders came from Norway. Anders Calder crossed the Atlantic on a ship at sixteen, "or that's what my father always said," Ruth added, and he did it in one pair of boots, which he wore the whole way across. "My father loved to tell that one."

In Duluth he found work on the ore boats, loading iron ore at the docks. "That's where the work was," Ruth said.

THE RECORDS

What this chapter rests on. Two passages of Ruth's recorded interview (session S1). No documents have been consulted. A passenger list or naturalization record would confirm or correct the crossing; see facts/gaps.md.

THE LINE OF DESCENT

Anders Calder (link from Norway unconfirmed)
↓
Ruth's father
↓
Ruth Calder (b. 1938) = Walt
↓
their children and grandchildren